SEO Discovery Report — example.com

Prepared by Scrolly Social · 2026-08-11 · Generated from `findings.md` (Mode 1, non-geo-bound)

> ***Read this first — two limitations shaped this entire report, and they are different things. 1. Data access.*** *Our paid search-data provider (DataForSEO) was not funded for this run, so* ***no*** *demand, SERP, competitor, ranking, keyword-difficulty, AI-Overview, or backlink data could be retrieved. Additionally, the free PageSpeed Insights API rate-limited us on all three attempts, so no performance data was obtained either. Every affected section below is kept and marked* ***"Not Evaluated / Data Required"*** *with exactly what would resolve it. Nothing was estimated or invented to fill a gap.* ***2. The domain itself.*** `example.com` *is the internet's reserved documentation domain. We read the site directly and confirmed it hosts no business, no products, no services, and no contact information — its own text says "Avoid use in operations." Because of this, several sections would remain unanswerable* ***even with full data funding****. Where that is the case, we say so specifically rather than blaming the data outage. Labels used throughout:* ***DIRECTLY OBSERVED*** *(we checked it ourselves) ·* ***API/RETRIEVED DATA*** *(automated pull) ·* ***CALCULATED*** *·* ***INFERENCE*** *·* ***SCENARIO*** *·* ***PENDING VALIDATION****.*

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1. Executive Opportunity Summary

Biggest organic-search opportunity	**Not Evaluated / Data Required.** No opportunity could be identified — not because we found the opportunity to be small, but because the two inputs required to find one (search demand data, and a real business offering) were both absent.
Biggest current weakness	The domain has no commercial content, no conversion mechanism, and no business identity — confirmed by direct observation, independent of any data outage.
Strongest existing SEO advantage	A clean, fast-loading, HTTPS-secured single page with a correct title tag, a single H1, no broken links, and no image debt. Small, but genuinely healthy — see §2.
Best near-term win	The four evidenced technical fixes in §22 (robots.txt, XML sitemap, meta description, Organization schema). Real and actionable — but they will not produce business value while the domain has nothing to sell.
Highest-value long-term opportunity	**Not Evaluated / Data Required.**
Overall recommendation	**HOLD.** Do not invest in organic search *at this domain* in its current state. This is a verdict on the evidence available for this engagement — **not** a finding that organic search is a weak channel for the underlying business.
Risks / dependencies	Everything commercial in this report depends on two unblocks: (1) funding the search-data provider, (2) pointing the analysis at a real operating website with a stated offering. Also flagged, not recommended: backlink disavowal, domain migration/rebrand, and site redesign — see §29.

SEO Scorecard

Area	Status
Technical SEO (H)	**Mixed** — 5 checks passed, 2 fix-now, 2 improve, 4 not evaluated
Website architecture (C)	**Critical Gap** — one page, no navigation, no hierarchy

On-page SEO (D)	**Critical Gap** — no topic coverage on the only page
Organic visibility (A)	**Not Evaluated / Data Required**
Local visibility (I)	**Not Applicable** — non-geo-bound business
Google Business Profile / local ecosystem (I)	**Not Applicable** — non-geo-bound business
Keyword opportunity (O3/O4)	**Not Evaluated / Data Required**
Content opportunity (O9)	**Not Evaluated / Data Required** (pending further research)
Competition (A)	**Not Evaluated / Data Required**
Backlinks / authority (G)	**Not Evaluated / Data Required**
Organic conversion readiness (L)	**Critical Gap** — confirmed zero conversion mechanisms
Analytics / measurement readiness (K)	**Critical Gap** — confirmed nothing to measure; GSC/GA4 also unverified
AI discovery / readiness (M)	**Not Yet Established**

2. Current Wins

Required section — we never send a report containing only weaknesses. These wins are small but real and **DIRECTLY OBSERVED**:

What is winning	Where	Why it matters	How to protect / expand it
HTTPS is correctly implemented	`https://example.com/`, HTTP 200	Security is a baseline ranking and trust requirement; you are not starting from a deficit here	Keep the certificate current; enforce HTTP→HTTPS redirects when the site expands
Clean, valid heading structure	Single H1, "Example Domain"	Multiple or missing H1s are among the most common on-page faults; yours is correct	Preserve the one-H1-per-page pattern on every new page
Title tag present and unique	/	No duplicate-metadata problem exists	Rewrite for commercial intent when the page gets a business purpose
Zero broken links	Whole site; single outbound link to iana.org resolves	Broken links waste crawl budget and harm trust	Re-check after any expansion
No image or asset debt	Whole site	No missing alt text, oversized files, or missing dimensions to remediate	Set alt-text and sizing standards *before* adding images

No content cannibalization or duplication	Whole site	Competing pages are a common and expensive problem to unwind later	Map intent-to-page once, up front, as you build

Not evaluated as wins, for lack of data: existing organic rankings · Local Pack/Maps rankings · strong geographic markets · pages already generating visibility · existing keyword positions · successful product categories · useful backlinks · review/reputation strengths · SERP features already captured. **These are unmeasured, not confirmed absent.**

3. Technical SEO Analysis

Full itemized audit — rendered here in the main report, not compressed to a summary.

FIX NOW

Issue	Severity	Evidence	Page(s)	Why it matters	Recommended fix	Priority
No `robots.txt`	Low–Medium (absence is permissive, so this is not a crawl blocker)	HTTP 404 — DIRECTLY OBSERVED	Site-wide	You have no explicit crawl directives and no conventional place to declare your sitemap	Publish `robots.txt` with crawl rules and a `Sitemap:` line	Medium
No XML sitemap	Low–Medium at current scale	HTTP 404 at `/sitemap.xml` — DIRECTLY OBSERVED	Site-wide	Negligible impact on one page; becomes a real discovery problem as soon as the site grows	Publish an XML sitemap and reference it from robots.txt	Medium

IMPROVE

Issue	Severity	Evidence	Page(s)	Why it matters	Recommended fix	Priority
No meta description	Low	Not surfaced in the rendered read — DIRECTLY OBSERVED (Moderate confidence: rendered read, not raw-source inspection)	/	You cede control of your search snippet	Write a description once the page has a commercial purpose	Low

No structured data / schema	Medium	Not surfaced in the rendered read — DIRECTLY OBSERVED (Moderate confidence, same caveat)	/	Schema is how search engines and AI systems resolve you into a known entity — see §16/§17	Add Organization schema plus page-appropriate types once real business information exists	Medium

PASSED

HTTPS + HTTP 200 · exactly one H1, no hierarchy conflict · title tag present and unique · no duplicate metadata · zero broken internal or external links · no image issues (no images to have issues) · no cannibalization · no duplicate content. **These passed checks are retained in full even though problems were also found.**

NOT EVALUATED / DATA NEEDED

Test	What would resolve it
Indexation status; noindex directives; canonical tags and canonical conflicts	GSC access (read-only), or one funded on-page call
HTTP→HTTPS redirect behavior; www/non-www consolidation; canonical domain consistency	Same as above
Redirects, redirect chains/loops, 3XX issues, 4XX/5XX inventory, crawl failures	A site crawl. Note: our provider's on-page tools appear to operate per-URL, so full-site crawl coverage is itself unconfirmed
Duplicate-URL/indexation problems; important unindexed pages; blocked pages/resources; orphan-page signals	Crawl + GSC coverage
Mobile rendering and mobile usability	Lighthouse/PSI (see §4)
Manual-action / penalty signals	GSC access only — not detectable otherwise, and never guessed

4. Lighthouse / Performance Error Analysis

Not Evaluated / Data Required. Two separate reasons, both reported:

Reason 1 — the tool was rate-limited. We attempted the free PageSpeed Insights API (our declared substitute for the paid Lighthouse tool) three times: mobile with all four categories, a reduced single-category retry, and a retry against the alternate Google host. All three returned **HTTP 429 Too Many Requests.**

- *What was tested:* PSI v5 against `https://example.com/`, mobile, ×3.
- *What was confirmed:* only that the keyless PSI quota is exhausted for our IP.
- *What could not be verified:* all four category scores (Performance, Accessibility, Best Practices, SEO); LCP, INP, CLS, FCP, TBT, Speed Index, TTFB; and every required diagnostic — render-blocking resources, unused JS/CSS, JS execution, bundle size, main-thread blocking, DOM size, server response time, image

sizing/format/compression, missing image dimensions, lazy-loading, font loading, third-party scripts, caching, network dependency chains, redirects, layout shifts, LCP element, mobile usability. **No severity or scope classification could be assigned to any performance issue.**
- *What would resolve it:* a free PSI API key (fixes this immediately), or funding the paid Lighthouse tool. One call then covers the homepage.

Reason 2 — the required multi-page-type sampling was impossible regardless. This section requires testing a homepage *plus* a service/product page, category page, location page, blog/article, and major landing page. **This site has only a homepage.** Even with working performance data we could have tested exactly one page type, and homepage results must never be assumed to represent other templates. This is a property of the site, not a step we skipped.

5. Analytics & Measurement Readiness

One confirmed finding and two unverified areas — we never assume analytics are correct merely because they might exist.

- **CONFIRMED (DIRECTLY OBSERVED): lead attribution is currently impossible.** The site has no form, no phone number, no booking flow, and no ecommerce. Forms, calls, bookings, purchases, and quote requests cannot be tracked because none of them exist. *Action: create a conversion mechanism first, instrument it second — tracking cannot precede the thing being tracked.*
- **Not Evaluated / Data Required — Google Search Console:** property verification, clicks, impressions, queries, pages, coverage/indexing, sitemap status, crawl issues, and manual-action/security warnings. Access was not authorized. *Action: grant read-only GSC access — it is the only source of directly observed organic traffic and would raise confidence across §14, §20, and §3.*
- **Not Evaluated / Data Required — GA4:** installation correctness, duplicate tags, misconfiguration, event tracking, conversions/key events, attribution. *Action: grant GA4 access so this can be verified rather than assumed.*

6. Website Structure & Page Architecture

Current structure (DIRECTLY OBSERVED): exactly one URL (`/`), targeting nothing commercial. No navigation. Zero internal links.

Recommended structure: Not Evaluated / Data Required. CREATE is the only classification that could apply — Retain, Update/Expand, Rewrite, Consolidate, Redirect, and Reposition are all inapplicable because there is nothing but a placeholder page. But *what* to create cannot be responsibly specified: we would be inventing pages from nothing, and our standing rule is that we never recommend a page, product, or category solely because keyword demand exists — and here we do not even have demand data.

Page sections (services, products, categories, pricing/cost, FAQs, process, service areas, inventory, reviews/testimonials, trust signals, credentials, guarantees, about/expertise, CTAs, internal links, comparison content, related resources) likewise cannot be specified per page, because no pages exist to add sections to. *What would resolve it: a stated offering plus funded demand and competitor data — roughly 10–20 paid calls, well within our authorized budget.*

7. Keyword Opportunity Analysis

Not Evaluated / Data Required. No keyword cluster could be built.

- **Confirmed Opportunities:** none. Requires a confirmed offering; the site names none.
- **Potential Opportunities / Verify Offering:** none. We would normally generate these from category knowledge even when a client's site is thin — but that requires knowing the *industry*, and this domain

identifies no industry at all. We will not invent one.
- Competitor keyword discovery and related-keyword expansion both required the unfunded provider.

Nothing here implies the business does or does not sell anything — we simply have no basis to say.

8. Keyword Competition & Expected Ranking Difficulty

Not Evaluated / Data Required. With no keyword set, no SERP data, no competitor authority measurement, and no keyword-difficulty metrics, **no difficulty rating (Low through Very High) is defensible, and no ranking timeframe can be estimated.** We will not offer a ranking-time range built on assumption — and we never guarantee ranking dates in any case. *Resolvable with SERP + difficulty + backlink data once funded.*

9. SERP Composition, AI Overviews & Zero-Click Risk

Not Evaluated / Data Required. We could not inspect a single live SERP, so we cannot tell you whether AI Overviews, Local Packs, featured snippets, People Also Ask, video, images, shopping results, forum/Reddit results, or direct-answer features occupy your target searches — and therefore cannot judge whether ranking well would even produce clicks. This matters enough that we won't approximate it: identical search volume does not mean identical traffic opportunity when SERP layouts differ. *Resolvable with ~5–15 SERP pulls once funded.*

10. Competitive Landscape

Not Evaluated / Data Required. No competitor was identified, and — importantly — **none was assumed.** Our method selects competitors from evidence of actual organic capture across your commercial clusters, never from guesswork or from a client's offline competitor list. With no SERP or ranked-keyword data, and no client-supplied competitor names, that evidence base is empty.

Consequently **WHY THEY ARE WINNING** and **HOW YOU CAN COMPETE** are both unanswerable at this time. We flag rather than fabricate: a plausible-sounding competitor list would be worse than an honest blank. *Resolvable with ~4–8 calls once funded.*

11. Google Business Profile & Local Search

Not Applicable — retained and marked, not dropped. Intake declares this business non-geo-bound, and the site read found no address or phone (consistent with, though not proof of, that declaration). GBP configuration, review profile, NAP/citation consistency, Local Pack visibility, and city-level opportunity are therefore all out of scope. **No location pages are recommended anywhere in this report** — we never build thin doorway pages.

If the business is in fact local, adding physical location(s) to intake re-activates this entire section plus the full geographic-market analysis. Separately worth knowing: reviews/reputation and citation/NAP consistency have **no available tool in our current paid data provider** — even for a local client, those two would require an additional source.

12. Organic Conversion Readiness

Critical Gap — confirmed by direct observation, not a data gap. The single page has: no CTA · no phone number or click-to-call · no form · no booking flow · no reviews, testimonials, credentials, or guarantees · no about/expertise content · no product or service clarity · no pricing information · no visual proof. **Any organic traffic this page received would convert at zero, by construction** — there is nothing for a visitor to do.

On a real commercial site this is a top-priority fix: one unambiguous primary CTA, a visible click-to-call phone number, a short low-friction form, and trust signals placed next to the CTA. Mobile conversion friction could not be

assessed (no performance data, §4). This is a focused SEO-ROI review, **not** a full CRO engagement, and we are not recommending a redesign on this basis alone.

13. Blog & Informational Content Opportunity

Not Evaluated / Data Required — labeled "Pending further research."

We are required to tell you the honest number here, and to separately flag when the *research itself* was incomplete. This is the latter case: **zero of the 16 applicable discovery paths could be executed** (keyword expansion, competitor ranking keywords, competitor content, People Also Ask, search suggestions, question modifiers, cost queries, comparisons, alternatives, product/service variants, use cases, problem queries, seasonal searches, buying guides, FAQ clusters, industry terminology). **This is a research-completeness gap, not a finding that your content opportunity is small.** No launch list is provided, and we did not pad one. We also make **no publishing-cadence recommendation** — cadence is never decided before the real topic universe is known.

14. Full Content Map

Not Evaluated / Data Required. See `appendix.md` — the schema is retained with an explicit insufficient-evidence record. Target for a funded run: approximately 100–400 defensible opportunities where the evidence supports it.

15. Backlink & Authority Analysis

Not Evaluated / Data Required — section retained per our non-regression rule. Backlink quantity, referring domains, link quality, spam/problematic links, competitor authority, and the authority gap are all unmeasured. **No classification (Critical blocker / Meaningful weakness / Secondary opportunity / Healthy for current stage) is defensible**, and we are not guessing at one.

Two things we *can* tell you now:

- **Backlink disavowal is not recommended** — we never auto-prescribe it. Flagged in §29 as requiring professional judgment.
- **A forward-looking caution:** `example.com` is linked from an enormous number of technical documentation pages worldwide. Any future backlink pull on this domain will look anomalously strong. That is an artifact of the domain's reserved status, **not** earned commercial authority, and must not be read as one.

Resolvable with ~4 calls once funded.

16. AI Discovery & Readiness

Classification: Not Yet Established. Deliberately not "Weak" — "Weak" would imply we tested and found you absent. We could not test: there are no priority topics to prompt with (the site names no offering), and AI-Overview presence could not be captured because no SERP data was retrievable. Whether competitors, publishers, directories, forums, or video sources appear instead is therefore unknown.

What we *did* determine by direct observation: the site provides **no first-party, specific information** of any kind — nothing an AI system could understand, cite, or attribute. Crawlability/indexability of important pages, the precondition for AI citability, is also unverified (§3).

What would resolve it: once a real offering and topic set exist, we run priority prompts through consumer AI search surfaces manually and record what appears — this does not require paid tooling. **No "GEO hacks" are recommended**; the fixes worth making here (real information, clear structure, valid schema) serve human readers and traditional search identically.

17. Entity & Business Information Readiness

Confirmed absent — DIRECTLY OBSERVED. Business name, business type, services, products, locations/service areas, hours, contact information, expertise, key people, and organization relationships are **all missing**, and no schema was found. There is nothing for a search engine or AI system to resolve into an entity.

The required cross-surface consistency check (website · schema · GBP · citations · social profiles · about/contact pages · service pages) **cannot find inconsistencies because there is only one surface and it carries no information** — and there is no GBP (non-geo-bound). *Action: publish complete, consistent business information plus Organization schema, then re-run the consistency audit.*

18. Chatbot / Conversational Opportunity

Not recommended. This is a genuine judgment from evidence, not a data gap. There is no evidenced problem for a chatbot to solve: no repetitive customer questions, no product/service complexity, no lead qualification need, no service-area qualification, no quote intake, no booking process, no inventory or pricing questions, no after-hours inquiry volume, and no form friction (there is no form). We never recommend a chatbot merely because AI exists. *Re-evaluate only against a real business with evidenced inquiry volume or measurable form friction.*

19. Light AI Automation Opportunity

None recommended (light adjunct note). Lead routing, follow-up, inquiry classification, review-response assistance, CRM updates, and reporting all presuppose leads, reviews, or measurable traffic — none of which exist here.

20. Expected Organic Traffic Impact

Not Evaluated / Data Required. We are required to address traffic impact and not to omit projections merely because outcomes are unknowable — but scenarios must be built from observed positions × demand × a stated CTR range. **We have no observed positions and no demand data, so there is no first link in that chain.**

- **Current baseline:** unknown. Requires GSC access or ranked-keyword data.
- **Near-term / mid-term / longer-term scenarios:** cannot be modeled.

We specifically did **not** compute opportunity as "total search volume minus ranking volume" — that method is invalid regardless of data availability, and we would not use it even to produce a placeholder number. *Resolvable with ranked-keyword + demand data, or GSC access.*

21. Lead / Business Impact Scenarios

Not Evaluated / Data Required. Client economics were not supplied, so `client_specific_economics` is **"Not provided"** throughout — this is the normal, expected case and not a defect. Normally we would still give you a **commercial-value proxy** (High/Medium/Low, from demand, commercial intent, and category knowledge) — but that proxy needs demand and CPC data, which we could not retrieve. **No revenue forecast is fabricated.** Value from calls, Maps actions, direction requests, walk-ins, quote requests, and branded searches is not applicable here (non-geo-bound, and no contact mechanism exists).

22. Quick Wins

Only four defensible quick wins exist, all from directly observed technical evidence. We are stating plainly that they are technically correct but **commercially inert at this domain**:

Action	Why it matters	Expected impact	Effort	Priority	Dependencies
Publish `robots.txt` with crawl rules + `Sitemap:` line	Restores explicit crawl control and the conventional sitemap declaration	Low	Low	Medium	None
Publish an XML sitemap	Negligible at one page; essential as the site grows	Low now, Medium later	Low	Medium	Benefits from robots.txt existing
Add a meta description to `/`	Regains control of the search snippet	Low	Low	Low	Needs a real page purpose first
Add Organization schema	Enables entity recognition by search engines and AI systems (§16/§17)	Medium	Low	Medium	Requires real business information to exist

23. 30/60/90-Day Implementation Roadmap

Every item below traces to a finding in this report. This roadmap is unavoidably **unblock-first**, because the evidence base is the binding constraint.

Week 1 — remove the two blockers (traces to the header note, §5, §15, §20)

- Fund the search-data provider, or supply a free PageSpeed Insights API key. *Unblocks §4, §7–§10, §13–§15, §20.*
- Confirm the actual operating domain and state the business's real products/services. *Unblocks §1, §6, §7, §13, §16–§19, §21.*
- Grant read-only Google Search Console + GA4 access. *Unblocks §5 and the §20 baseline.*

Week 2 — the evidenced technical fixes (traces to §3, §22)

- Publish `robots.txt`; publish an XML sitemap; add a meta description; add Organization schema.
- Run the Lighthouse/performance audit across every page type that actually exists. *Traces to §4.*

Weeks 3–4 — re-run Discovery on real inputs

- With data access restored, re-run demand, SERP, competitor, ranked-keyword, and backlink retrieval (~20–40 calls, inside our authorized ceiling) and complete §6–§10, §13–§15, §20–§21.

Days 31–60 — build the commercial architecture. Cannot yet be specified per page. It becomes specifiable the moment the Weeks 3–4 re-run completes, and we will not pre-commit to pages invented without demand evidence.

Days 61–90 — first supporting content, authority work, conversion instrumentation. Sequenced after the money-page architecture exists. The conversion fixes in §12 (primary CTA, click-to-call, low-friction form, trust signals) should land alongside the first commercial pages, not after them.

24. Longer-Term SEO Roadmap

Page expansion, content growth, content updating, consolidation/pruning, backlink acquisition, digital PR/local authority, location expansion, conversion optimization, ranking monitoring, competitor monitoring, seasonal planning, and measurement refinement are all **deferred pending the §23 Week 1 unblocks.** None can be

responsibly scoped from the current evidence base. Two are already known to be inapplicable as scoped: **location expansion** (non-geo-bound) and **seasonal planning** (no category identified, so no seasonality signal).

25. Visual Evidence

None included. Screenshots exist to prove or explain a finding, never to decorate a report. The findings we can support (a two-sentence placeholder page; two HTTP 404s) are fully conveyed in text. The findings that *would* warrant visual evidence — current rankings, significant SERPs, Lighthouse diagnostics, competitor examples, architecture diagrams — are precisely the ones with no underlying data. *This section becomes populated once §23's Week 1 unblocks are done.*

26. Social / Platform Search Visibility

Not Evaluated / Data Required (secondary section, kept brief). No branded entity exists at this domain to search for, so we cannot assess whether branded profiles surface in Google, whether public social content is indexed, or whether YouTube/Instagram/TikTok/Pinterest/Reddit repeatedly occupy target SERPs. *Resolvable alongside the §9 SERP pulls. This never substitutes for core organic work.*

27. Measurement Plan

Measurement cannot begin until §5's gaps are closed — but the plan itself is fixed now, so tracking starts on day one of implementation rather than being retrofitted:

Checkpoint	What to review
30 days	GSC verified and collecting · indexed-page count · crawl/coverage errors resolved · conversion tracking live and firing
60 days	GSC impressions and query visibility appearing for target clusters · first ranking movement (movement, not position targets)
90 days	Organic sessions · clicks · money-page rankings · conversion events · leads/calls/bookings/transactions
180 days	Ranking consolidation on priority clusters · content performance by topic · referring-domain growth
365 days	Organic revenue contribution · full-funnel attribution · competitor position shift

Local Pack visibility, GBP interactions, and review velocity are **not applicable** (non-geo-bound). **Rankings are not the business outcome** — leads, calls, bookings, and revenue are. A ranking improvement that produces no enquiries has not succeeded, and we will report it that way.

28. Scope & Next Steps

This $300 Discovery Report includes: strategy, diagnosis, prioritization, and opportunity discovery — plus, in this instance, an explicit and itemized account of what could not be evaluated and exactly what would resolve each gap.

It does NOT include: website implementation · site redesign · writing the recommended pages · writing the blog backlog · ongoing SEO management · link-building execution · ongoing GBP management · ongoing analytics reporting.

Honest next step for this engagement: this report cannot be sold as a completed opportunity analysis, because the opportunity analysis could not be performed. **Recommended action: close the two blockers in §23 Week 1 and re-run Discovery.** The re-run is fully specified and costed in `data-plan.md` and sits comfortably inside the authorized data budget.

Paths available afterward: DIY (you follow the roadmap) · **Implementation** (Scrolly Social implements the priority recommendations) · **Ongoing SEO** (Scrolly Social manages implementation, content, optimization, and measurement).

29. Flagged Considerations — Judgment Required, Not Prescribed

Deliberately excluded from the prioritized action list above:

Consideration	Our position
Backlink disavowal	Not recommended. Never auto-prescribed. This domain's documentation-driven link profile will look anomalous in any future pull; that is not grounds for action.
Domain migration / rebrand	The logical implication of "this domain cannot host a business," but it is a business decision with brand and equity consequences we are not positioned to make for you.
Site redesign	Conversion friction here is total (§12), but we do not escalate a conversion review into a redesign mandate on that authority alone.

Report generated from `findings.md`. Supporting evidence, full schemas, per-category finding tables, and the complete research audit trail are in `appendix.md`.